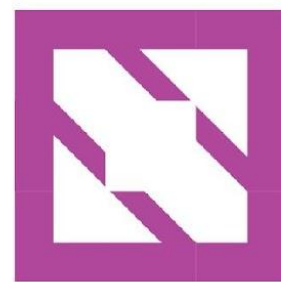




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Bridge the gap to OSS adoption with documentation: A Kubernetes story

Divya Mohan, SUSE

Natali Vlatko, Cisco



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Hi there, we're (some of) SIG Docs!



- Principal Technology Advocate @ SUSE
- SIG Docs co-chair
- Kubernetes Code of Conduct



- Open Source Architect and OSPO Lead @ Cisco
- SIG Docs co-chair
- TODO Group Steering Committee

OSS documentation is regarded as a significant resource for making decisions concerning the adoption of open source software

Source: <https://arxiv.org/html/2403.03819v1>

Kubernetes is the second largest open source project in the world after Linux and is the primary container orchestration tool for 71% of Fortune 100 companies

Source: <https://www.cncf.io/reports/kubernetes-project-journey-report/>

Why we're here today



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 **rebootsolvesthings** · 1mo ago
I find the official Kubernetes docs really useful, the quick examples are a nice bonus
I do like a book to refer to as well though from time to time - sometimes I hear of a new tool or functionality that I've not come across before
YouTube/Pluralsight/Udemy etc just doesn't sink in for me at times tbh

 **ajeetsraina** · 1y ago
There is no single cookbook to master the Kubernetes concepts. The best resource is Kubernetes docs portal <https://kubernetes.io>. It could be overwhelming because there are tons of concepts and material out there. Remember that Kubernetes has been there since last 9 years.

 **r/kubernetes moneyppt** · 4 mo. ago
Kubernetes doc is soo cool that it needs an appreciation post just for it's sheer awesomeness. Every page is like a love letter for devops folks 😄

 **raftx_** · 2y ago
I super recommend the K8s docs. More specifically this section
<https://kubernetes.io/docs/concepts/>
Plenty of useful stuff to get you going.

How did we achieve this feat?

Agenda

- Tackling the proximity problem
- Walking in the user's shoes
- Embracing different voices
- Using the Minto Pyramid
- Community-driven development
- Things we'd like to improve

The proximity problem

What is the proximity problem?



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The closer you are to a group, the more you interact with that group. But you can't be everywhere at once, so you have to choose the group that gets priority. Given these dynamics, is it better to be embedded within project teams or within a technical writing team?

Source: Tom Johnson, <https://idratherbewriting.com/2011/09/23/the-proximity-problem/>

What is the proximity problem?



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Technical documentation needs to be
readable (usable) AND technically accurate

What does the K8s project do?

We have docs requirements for different feature stages and implementations *for KEP* owners*

KEP = Kubernetes Enhancement Proposal: <https://github.com/kubernetes/enhancements/tree/master/keps>

What does the K8s project do?

SIG Docs works with KEP owners to shape *how* docs are structured and presented to users, while the content (the *what*) is sourced from technical expertise of KEP owners

What does the K8s project do?

We (SIG Docs) represent the users of Kubernetes documentation: we set standards to make our docs usable, while KEP owners ensure the docs are technically accurate

What does the K8s project do?



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Navigating Cross SIG Collaborations with SIG Docs

*Rey Lejano & Savitha Raghunathan, Red Hat;
Divya Mohan, SUSE; Xander Grzywinski, Defense Unicorns*

Walking in the user's shoes

Who uses the Kubernetes docs and
what do they need from them?

Beginners to Kubernetes: Concepts, how-to's

Kubernetes developers: API reference
documentation, etc

We focus on catering to different skill levels in our docs in a consistent, recognizable fashion to build technical knowledge for users

Embracing different voices

Technical writers use active voice to make documentation easier to read and to acknowledge that there is a subject (user) with responsibility

Microsoft Writing Style Guide: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/style-guide/welcome/>

We address the reader/documentation user as “you”, use active voice, and use direct language for readability AND to enable contributions to the docs

Kubernetes Documentation Style Guide: <https://kubernetes.io/docs/contribute/style/style-guide/>

Using the Minto pyramid

The Minto Pyramid principle: A framework for documentation that structures information like a pyramid; the most important takeaway is at the top

The Minto Pyramid: <https://tettra.com/article/minto-pyramid-principle/>

Why use the Minto Pyramid?

79% of online readers strictly skim the content they read; we employ scannable text principles in our documentation style

How Users Read on the Web: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/how-users-read-on-the-web/>

Why are users reading docs?



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We think about different use cases for using the Kubernetes docs: folks taking certification exams (CKA, CKAD) is a focus for documentation structure

Community-driven development

We need continuous contributions

Documentation is never perfect or complete in Kubernetes: 3 releases a year, 16 localizations, versioned documentation supported, and more!

Would the docs be improved with a certain change? We encourage PRs that are *good enough*

Each contribution has an engineering cost: focus on giving an entire file a review, as opposed to trivial edits. Ask yourself: can this doc be further improved?

Trivial edits on Kubernetes docs: <https://www.kubernetes.dev/docs/guide/pull-requests/#trivial-edits>

We ask for feedback on Kubernetes docs via issues and feedback buttons:

Feedback

Was this page helpful?

Yes

No

-  [Edit this page](#)
-  [Create child page](#)
-  [Create an issue](#)
-  [Print entire section](#)

What we'd like to improve

SIG Docs and You: Modernizing API Reference Generation - Kat Cosgrove & Xander Grzywinski, Independent

📅 Thursday April 3, 2025 16:45 - 17:15 BST

📍 Platinum Suite | Level 3 | Room 3-4

The Kubernetes project has some of the best documentation in the industry, and it's part of the reason for the project's success. Writing and maintaining that documentation requires the help of a small army of contributors, but there's an often unseen aspect to the documentation that still needs work: the API reference docs generator. SIG Docs is beginning work to overhaul this process, and we need you! Learn more about how the reference docs are currently generated, the technical problems we face with that process, our plans for the future, and how you can get involved in ensuring the Kubernetes documentation continues to be the best it can be.

Blog subproject



sftim



3:40 PM

Having a chat with SIG chairs about the blog and the team



53 replies [View thread](#)

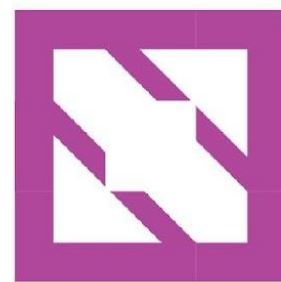
You can help the docs!

1. Join Kubernetes Slack <https://slack.k8s.io>
 - a. Join #sig-docs Slack channel
2. Read our contributing guide
 - a. Contributing to the Kubernetes Docs
<https://kubernetes.io/docs/contribute/docs/>
 - b. Be familiar with the PR process
3. Join the SIG's mailing list to get calendar invites:
<https://groups.google.com/g/kubernetes-sig-docs/>
4. Attend SIG meetings

5. Watch Intro videos and talks from SIG Docs
 - a. Intro to Kubernetes Docs - Celeste Horgan, Brad Topol, Tim Bannister:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pprMgmNzDcw>
6. Attend the monthly New Contributor Meet & Greet, first Tuesday of the month 10:30 UTC



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